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Feisty mayor vows to tax rich

At City Club, cheers for Johnson’s vision, not plan to pay for it

By Alice Yin and Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson accused the city’s corporate class of ignoring Black and brown lives Wednesday in a wide-ranging speech to a crowd of business leaders who cheered his ideas but greeted with silence his promise to pay for them by taxing the rich.

The appearance at the City Club of Chicago was Johnson’s first major public speech since announcing his reelection campaign a little over two weeks ago, and signals that he is entering his fight for a second term — and his fourth budget — with as feisty a message as ever.

After quipping that the crowd’s applause as he took the stage was a sign he will be strong heading into the February election, Johnson delivered a sermon-style address, heavy on religious rhetoric, where he contrasted the “absence of crime” with the “absence of investment.”

On the absence of crime, he nodded to the 300-plus homicides so far in 2026 as still far too many, before reminiscing about taking his eldest son to college this summer.

“I allow myself to imagine a day where every parent in Austin and every parent in Chicago, where they get to miss their kid because they dropped him off at college, and not because of violence,” Johnson said. “That’s the world ... I won’t stop building, no matter how many converging forces try to bully us into austerity

See **MAYOR** on Page A2

Election Day threats loom

Lawsuits aim to stop FBI, ICE at the polls

By Rick Pearson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Before federal immigration agents stormed across the Chicago region last year and President Donald Trump threatened to

send in the National Guard, Gov. JB Pritzker warned both moves aimed to “normalize” a federal military presence to intimidate voters and depress turnout in the 2026 midterms.

Some at the time viewed Pritzker’s contention as a bit of a stretch, given federal laws prohibit armed civil or military personnel at the polls and state laws bar election

interference. But as the immigration surge grew chaotic, combative and deadly in Chicago through Operation Midway Blitz and in other operations throughout the country, the governor’s concerns gained traction.

Now, citing recent comments by Trump and top administration officials, voting rights activists and Democratic officials have filed at

least two lawsuits in federal court in Washington that seek to block what they contend is a “polling place policy” that would allow U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement and FBI agents to operate in or around polling places.

At the same time, local county

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IN FULL GLOOM

People with umbrellas race across the Michigan Avenue DuSable Bridge in the rain following a bridge lift on Wednesday. A forecast of widespread rain is expected again throughout Chicagoland all day Thursday, according to the National Weather Service. The area will see between 1.5 and 3 inches of rainfall from Wednesday through Thursday night.

ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

AL WILD-CARD SERIES GAME 2 WHITE SOX 7, ASTROS 3



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Sox blasting off into the ALDS

Shortstop Colson Montgomery celebrates after the White Sox swept the Astros on Wednesday, securing an ALDS matchup with Cleveland. Full coverage of the Sox — and the Cubs’ bid to stay alive — in **Sports**.

Pope’s ballclub enjoying its Mass appeal

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Whether or not the White Sox make it deep into the playoffs this season, there’s one thing you can never take away from them: They’ll

always have “Pope Hat” night.

Two seasons after setting an MLB record for futility with a record 121 losses, the White Sox are in the postseason, the fans are back in the fold and the team is leveraging its success with increased atten-

dance, TV ratings and some very creative promotions.

Throw in some divine intervention with the first Chicago pope confessing his allegiance

See **SOX** on Page A4

After 12 years, final US troops leave Iraq

By Qassim Abdul-Zahra and Michelle L. Price
ASSOCIATED PRESS

BAGHDAD — The U.S. military announced Wednesday that it completed the withdrawal of all American troops from Iraq, ending a 12-year mission to fight the Islamic State group and prompting President Donald Trump to hail the conclusion of “a very expensive excursion into Hell.”

The last U.S. troops left an air base in northern Iraq under a deal between Baghdad and Washington.

Trump, in a social media post, described the withdrawal by a Sept. 30 deadline as “orderly.” Appearing soon after at a White House event celebrating Hispanics, he spoke at length about the withdrawal and said, “It’s been a

long time with very bad decision making that got us involved in this quagmire in the first place. It was a quagmire. For many, many years it lasted. But soon that part of history will be over.”

He said the shift was a victory for the U.S., Iraq and a sign of victory over the Islamic State group.

The withdrawal, agreed on two years ago, comes against the backdrop of the ongoing war between the United States and Iran that has also sometimes spilled over into Iraq, with Iran-backed militias firing on U.S. troops and the U.S. striking the groups’ strongholds.

Trump’s comments came as his own decision earlier this year to launch the war with Iran has been compared to the Iraq war

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CHICAGOLAND

Revluri drops out of CPS race

Sendhil Revluri, a former Chicago School Board appointee, is dropping out of the race to be the first elected board president. Revluri said Wednesday he was suspending his campaign in part because he is unable to compete with labor unions and other special interest groups.

BUSINESS

Another HQ for Loop icon

Chicago-based investment firm Morningstar said on Wednesday it will move its global headquarters into the James R. Thompson Center, the downtown landmark getting renovated by Google. The decision gives another boost to the long-anticipated revival of the ex-state office building.

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